HUMAN RESOURCES & COMPANY POLICIES

Employee Handbook & Operational Guide

Apex Global Technologies Inc. — Organizational Policies, Culture, and Standards

Effective Date: January 1, 2026 **Version:** 4.2 (Annual Revision) **Classification:** Confidential — Internal **Owner:** People Operations & Legal

1. Welcome and Company Overview

Welcome to Apex Global Technologies. As an enterprise software and artificial intelligence solutions provider, our mission is to build robust, ethical, and transformative technology platforms that empower organizations worldwide. Our success rests upon three core pillars: **Engineering Rigor**, **Customer Obsession**, and **Transparent Collaboration**.

This Employee Handbook serves as a foundational guide to understanding our operating principles, workplace culture, performance standards, and employment policies. Every team member is responsible for reading, understanding, and adhering to the standards set forth in this document.

> **Core Operating Principle: High Trust with Full Accountability**
>
> Apex operates on high trust paired with clear accountability. Team members are empowered to make impactful decisions within their domain while adhering to rigorous engineering, ethical, and compliance standards.

2. Employment Classifications and Nature of Employment

Employment at Apex Global Technologies is categorized into defined classifications to ensure clarity regarding compensation, overtime eligibility, and statutory benefits:

- **Regular Full-Time:** Employees scheduled to work at least 40 hours per standard working week. Eligible for complete corporate health, retirement, equity, and paid time off benefits.
- **Regular Part-Time:** Employees scheduled to work fewer than 30 hours per week. Eligible for prorated statutory benefits as required by local jurisdiction.
- **Temporary / Interns:** Team members engaged for a defined project duration (typically 3 to 6 months). Eligible for hourly compensation and baseline statutory protections.
- **Independent Contractors / Consultants:** Specialized service providers operating under an executed Statement of Work (SOW) and Master Services Agreement (MSA), governed by contract law rather than employment payroll.

3. Working Hours, Time Tracking, and Core Collaboration Windows

Apex maintains core operational collaboration windows to ensure high-velocity cross-functional execution across our distributed engineering hubs:

- **Core Business Hours:** 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM local hub time (Monday through Friday). During core hours, all team members are expected to be available for synchronized meetings, collaborative architecture reviews, and active communication on enterprise channels (Slack and Google Meet).
- **Flexible Bandwidth:** Full-time exempt staff have flexibility to schedule remaining working hours between 7:00 AM and 7:00 PM local time to fulfill their weekly 40-hour commitment.

- **Time Logging & Overtime:** Non-exempt employees must accurately log all working hours, breaks, and project allocations in the BambooHR portal daily. Overtime work (>40 hours/week) must be pre-approved in writing by the departmental Director.

4. Employee Responsibilities and Workplace Expectations

As professionals representing Apex, all employees are held to high standards of operational excellence and integrity:

- **Professional Accountability:** Delivering committed work sprint goals, proactively communicating blockers during daily standups, and maintaining documentation.
- **Communication SLAs:** Responding to internal messages on Slack within 2 business hours during core windows, and acknowledging customer tickets or enterprise emails within 4 business hours.
- **Protection of Intellectual Property:** All software code, models, documentation, patents, and business methodologies developed using company infrastructure or during employment remain the sole intellectual property of Apex Global Technologies.
- **Care of Company Assets:** Employees must safeguard all assigned IT equipment (laptops, security keys, monitors) and report any damage, loss, or theft immediately to IT Security.

5. Compensation, Payroll, and Performance Management

Component	Schedule & Structure	Details & Guidelines
Payroll Cycle	Semi-monthly (15th and last business day)	Direct deposit to employee's designated bank account via ADP/Workday payroll system.
Performance Reviews	Quarterly OKRs & Annual Review	Quarterly Objectives and Key Results (OKRs) evaluated each quarter; formal compensation review conducted in November.
Merit & Bonus	Annual performance bonus (Q1 payout)	Discretionary bonus based on company ARR attainment, departmental targets, and individual rating (1-5 scale).

6. Benefits, Wellness, and Professional Development

Apex provides competitive benefits designed to support employee well-being and long-term career growth:

- **Health Coverage:** Premium health, dental, and vision insurance with 90% company contribution for employees and 75% for dependents.
- **Retirement Match:** 401(k) / Provident Fund matching up to 5% of base salary with immediate 100% vesting.
- **Learning & Development (L&D):** Annual personal education budget of $1,500 for technical certifications (AWS, GCP, CISA), conferences, and educational materials.
- **Wellness Stipend:** $75 monthly reimbursement for gym memberships, fitness trackers, or mental health counseling apps.

7. Workplace Safety, Harassment Prevention, and Grievance Redressal

Apex enforces a strict zero-tolerance policy against unlawful discrimination, harassment, bullying, and retaliation. Any employee experiencing or witnessing misconduct should report the incident to their Manager, People Operations

(`people-ops@apextech.internal`), or via our confidential Ethics Hotline (`1-800-ETHIC-APEX`). All reports are investigated promptly with confidentiality guaranteed.